



Gemeente
Amsterdam

Amsterdam Discovery plan 2024

A healthy, social city,
even during heat



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H1

Introduction

1.1 Why an Amsterdam heat plan

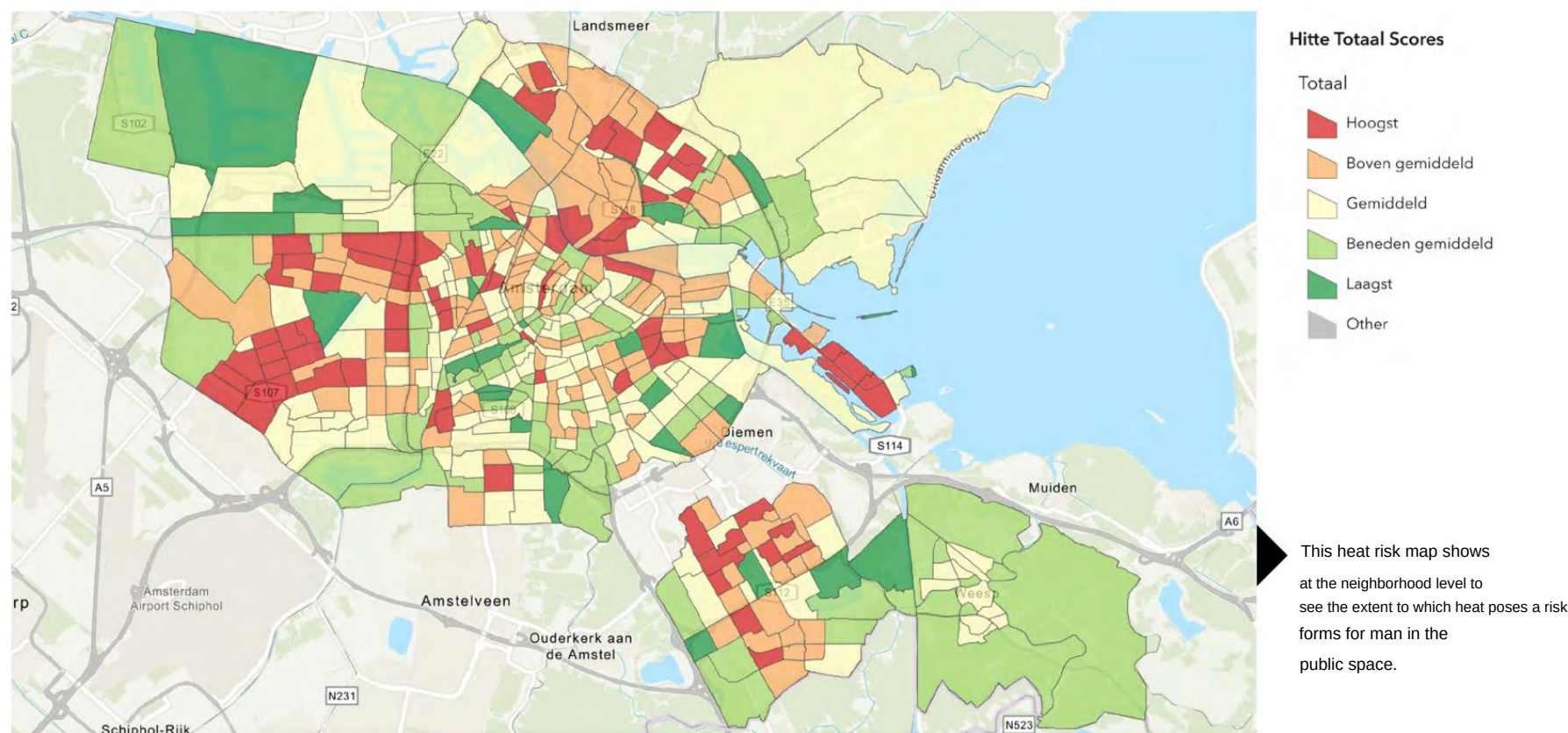
Due to climate change, the number of warm and tropical days is increasing, as described in the KNMI '23 scenarios. Heat combined with the urbanized layout of the city creates an urban heat island effect. As a result, it remains warm much longer at night than in rural areas. Heat not only causes discomfort for residents but can also lead to reduced labor productivity, health damage, and even mortality. Heat can lead to heat stress, which manifests as physical complaints because people are unable to dissipate heat and can become dehydrated. Particularly vulnerable groups such as the chronically ill, young children, the homeless, the elderly, and outdoor workers are at increased risk of health problems during hot days.

In 2020, the Amsterdam Climate Adaptation Strategy adopted. This maps out the consequences of climate change for Amsterdam and sets out the ambition to be as well prepared as possible for this by 2050. Some of the solutions for climate adaptation can be found in the design of public spaces, but specifically for the challenge surrounding heat, it is important to also look at the built environment and the social domain, because (adapting) behavior plays a major role in protecting people in vulnerable positions against the negative consequences of heat. Through research and the conduct of stress tests, we are gaining an increasingly clear picture of which locations, types of housing, and residents in the city are at the highest risk when it comes to heat issues.

The Amsterdam Heat Plan is part of a broad approach to better prepare Amsterdam for the consequences of climate change and complements the National Heat Plan.

1.2 Objective and target groups

The aim of implementing the Amsterdam Heat Plan is to prevent heat-related health and well-being problems, illness, and mortality as much as possible during a heatwave. This plan sets out how the municipality, GGD, GHOR, and others



Introduction

(Social) organizations carry out coordinated tasks and activities when the National Heat Plan is activated, so that people in vulnerable positions are reached during prolonged heat. Most of these organizations also have their own heat protocol containing specific actions for their own organization. The activities in the Amsterdam Heat Plan are primarily communicative activities focusing on awareness and knowledge sharing, in line with the National Heat Plan.

Through the development and annual renewal of the Amsterdam Heat Plan, various organizations come together to continue collaborating on tackling heat stress. At the same time, this provides a platform for the exchange of knowledge and experience, with the aim of focusing attention on residents with additional (care) needs. to improve needs during heatwaves in the municipality. This allows heat stress to be recognized at an early stage and serious consequences to be prevented.

Amsterdam's current heat plan focuses on supporting people in vulnerable positions during heatwaves, such as (but not limited to): • (Home-dwelling) elderly people with additional care needs • Very young children • Homeless people • People with serious health conditions

Vulnerability refers to the extent to which people and their resources experience negative consequences upon exposure to heatwaves. This vulnerability encompasses both sensitivity to heat and people's adaptability during heat. Sensitivity to heat depends not only on physical, psychological, and social health, but also on the design of the environment and the building. Groups that

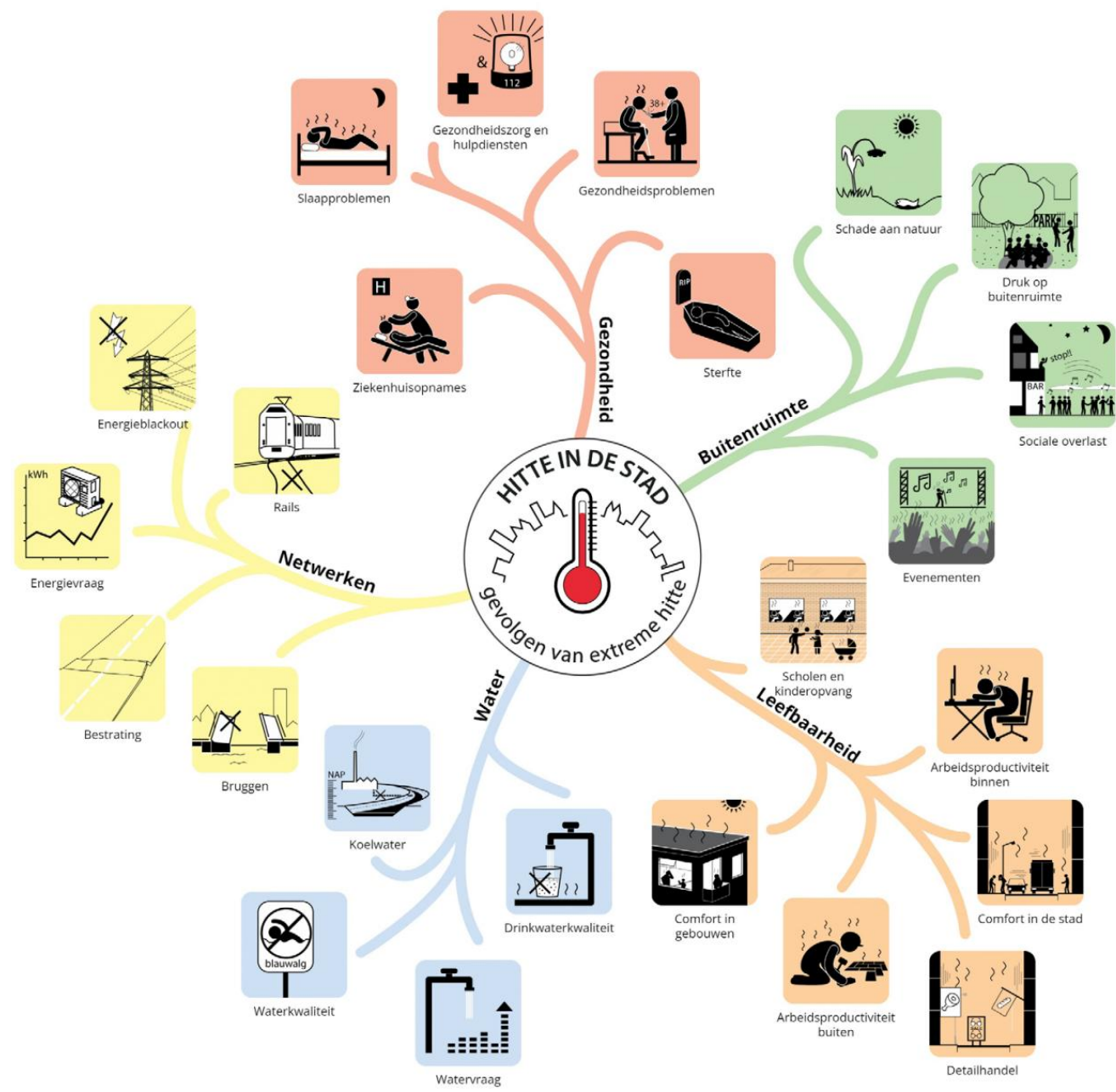


Figure 1:
Mind map Heat in the City -
HvA (April 2019)
Link to interactive version: Mind
map heat in the city
(hittebestendigestad.nl)

Those who are less able to adapt during heat also run a greater risk of heat stress, such as people living in poverty, homeless, or with a small social network. They may experience a greater impact during a heatwave because they have more limited resources to take preventive measures.

This plan currently aims exclusively to limit health risks. During the annual evaluation, consideration will be given to whether the scope should be expanded.

This first version of the local heat plan for Amsterdam was created in the autumn of 2022 by the Municipality of Amsterdam and the GGD Amsterdam in collaboration with a number of care and social organizations involved in caring for people in vulnerable positions or vital and vulnerable infrastructure in the city. At the beginning of the summer of 2022, we conducted a survey among the involved organizations, such as the Red Cross, neighborhood and district teams, and the homeless. care and local hospitals (see Chapter 4 for the organizations involved), including the question of what actions they take during heatwaves. After the summer, a large meeting was organized to evaluate the summer, which included two heatwaves. During this meeting, we gathered information on which actions had been taken and which actions were still missing. The outcomes of this day have been incorporated into this heat plan. The Amsterdam heat plan will be updated annually following an evaluation of the previous summer.

In this heat plan, the various phases are described in Chapter 2, and the implementation of the actions per phase is discussed in Chapter 3. Chapter 4 contains an overview of the participating organizations that were involved in the development of this heat plan.

[illegible]

Amsterdam Approach

2.1 The phase

The approach to heat consists of several phases. In Amsterdam, we have identified the following phases: preparation, pre-warning, warning, and finally, the annual evaluation. In addition to these various phases, prevention is very important. This is not a separate phase, but continues throughout the year.

Heat plan not the same as heatwave

The National Heat Plan is activated based on the weather forecast when there is a chance of a period of (more than) 4 days with a maximum temperature above 27 °C. This takes into account persistent heat and other criteria such as night temperature and humidity.

A heatwave can only be determined retrospectively. It is recognized when the temperature in De Bilt has been at least 25 degrees for at least 5 consecutive days, of which at least 3 days were above 30 degrees.



Prevention

all year round

One of the most important components of preventing health problems caused by heat is prevention. In principle, this takes place throughout the year and is not tied to a specific moment, and therefore does not constitute a separate phase in this heat plan. Part of prevention involves developing tools and measures to be deployed before a heatwave occurs. This entails sharing knowledge among healthcare professionals and people in vulnerable positions, encouraging behavioral change, strengthening networks, and providing advice on protocols and standards. Insights from this prevention process and new organizations wishing to join the Amsterdam heat plan can be incorporated into the heat plan's annual cycle.

Preparation phase

winter and spring

Even before the actual onset of heat, specific attention is paid during the preparation phase to possible actions and measures to reduce the impact of heatwaves on people in vulnerable positions. In this phase, the results of the autumn evaluation are integrated into the next version of the Amsterdam Heat Plan. The (revised) Amsterdam Heat Plan is coordinated with various parties, including healthcare organizations, the Safety Region, and shelters for the homeless, to gain a clear picture of everyone's responsibility during a heatwave.

Other actions include organizing preparation sessions, drafting or updating the communication strategy and the Code Red crisis situation plan.

Pre- warning phase

just before it gets hot

The pre-warning phase starts when the RIVM informs the GGD that a heatwave is expected. During this phase, everything is put in place to carry out the agreed actions, including the communication campaign, during the heatwave.

Warning phase

during hot days

The Amsterdam Heat Plan is activated during the warning phase. This takes place as soon as the National Heat Plan is activated by the RIVM, if a period of sustained heat or extremely high temperatures is expected. Not only the daytime temperature plays a role in this decision. The night temperature and the perceived temperature also play a role.

Temperature and humidity play an important role. The GGD Amsterdam receives notification regarding this from the RIVM and informs the coordinator of the heat plan. During this phase, actions and measures are aimed at limiting health risks, and activities are carried out in accordance with the heat plan. This includes, among other things, communication with persons in vulnerable positions and extra monitoring of the homeless.

Evaluation - and monitoring phase

autumn

In the autumn of 2024, a first evaluation of the Amsterdam Heat Plan will be organized with involved parties. The adjustments will be incorporated into the plan for 2025, and an evaluation will take place every year thereafter. The heat plan will be continuously adapted based on new insights.

Insights that do not fit into the heat plan, but are important for preventing heat stress, are incorporated elsewhere as effectively as possible.



H3

Execution



3.1 Prevention (year-round)

Organization	Taken
Local authority	Mapping the urban areas where people in vulnerable positions are located and which neighborhoods have the highest heat risk.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Developing, promoting, and publishing knowledge and information about heat and health on the municipal website / GGD website and sharing it with partner organizations.
Local authority	Mapping existing networks of partners in the city that can contribute to the goal of the heat plan.
GGD	Update information on heat and health on the GGD website, for both the general public and professionals.
Red Cross and other providers	Include recognizing heat stress in first aid courses.
Healthcare providers	Focus on recognizing heat stress in protocols.
Partners	Inform employees and volunteers about recognizing heat stress.
VrAA	Advising on heat during event permit issuance and checking whether a heat protocol is in place.
Municipality, GGD, VrAA	Advice on heat for occupational health and safety.
Housing associations & homeowners	Focus on improving the indoor climate through, for example, sun shading and insulation of homes.

Execution



3.2 Preparation phase (winter and spring)

Organization	Taken
Municipality and Public Health Service	Incorporating the results of the autumn evaluation and new knowledge into the next version of the Amsterdam Heat Plan.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Organizing a preparation session to discuss the tasks and responsibilities of all involved organizations.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Communication strategy in collaboration with communication advisors from the municipality and the GGD.
Municipal Health Service and Municipality	Prepare news report with updated figures and information on heat stress.
GGD	Check and annually update heat warning mailing list. See list of involved organizations.
GGD	Alert and inform health promoters/health brokers (if applicable).
Municipal Health Service, Municipality, Vraa	Preparing for a crisis situation (code red heat scenario).
All involved organizations	Investigate what else is possible. For example, research into potential cool places in the event of a crisis situation.
All involved organizations	Check internal heat protocols and send information to employees about what to do in case of heat.
All involved organizations	Team availability during the heatwave.

Execution



3.3 Pre-warning phase (based on RIVM message)

Organization	Taken
Municipality and Public Health Service	Draft a news item and press release and send them to the communications department for information/verification. Check duration, forecast, and attention to night temperatures. Make agreements regarding spokespersonship on behalf of the municipality and the GGD.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Review news item and press release for information/verification by the communications department and prepare for possible publication in the weekly magazine and on social media.
GGD	Forwarding preliminary warning to contacts on mailing list and final check of mailing list completeness.
GGD	Update mailing list (postmaster and mail delivery system emails).
GGD	Inform the relevant departments (Reception, IZB, JGZ, Childcare Centre Inspection, GL, FGK) of the GGD.
GGD	Inform local care network partners. Coordinate with municipalities regarding the involvement of umbrella organizations.
GGD	Inform municipalities and GHOR – forward preliminary warning.
GGD	Inform supply chain partners – forward advance warning.
Neighborhood teams, home care, general practitioners, homeless organizations	Inform employees about heat and health risks using existing flyers with infographics, sharing information about medication and heat, and concrete tips such as drinking enough water, staying indoors, keeping the sun out, and using sunscreen.
Waternet	Disseminating information about water taps in public spaces in the city.
Red Cross	Share prevention tips via flyers and social media.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Arrange team availability. Ensuring presence (especially during the summer period)

Execution



3.4 Warning phase (upon activation of RIVM National Heat Plan)

Organization	Taken
Municipality and Public Health Service	Place news item and press release by the communications department via the municipality.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Communication via social media, website.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Forward warning email to contacts on mailing list, supplemented with information material (RIVM Heat Toolkit).
Municipality and Public Health Service	Answering questions from organizations (volunteer organizations, municipalities, schools, and daycare centers), individual citizens, and healthcare providers based on existing Q&A.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Inform local care network partners.
Homeless organizations	Extend opening hours of childcare locations.
Red Cross	Assistance with events (e.g., the use of ice baths) and shelter for people in vulnerable positions (e.g., distributing water).

National search plan

The RIVM has shared a number of basic rules to limit heat stress. The basic rules listed below are observed by the cooperation partners at all times. Both the target group and our own employees are informed of these rules.

Know what to do when it gets hot!



Drink plenty of fluids

Drink water, tea, or coffee. Even if you are not thirsty, as older people have a reduced sense of thirst. Moderate your alcohol consumption.

Tip: make sure you always have a bottle of water with you, especially when you go outside or travel by car.



Keep your home cool

Keep the sun and heat out of your home as much as possible, for example with sun blinds, a fan, or air conditioning.

Tip: ensure extra cool, fresh air by opening windows and/or doors when it has cooled down outside.



Keep yourself cool

Stay in the shade and limit physical exertion in the afternoon (between 12:00 and 18:00).

Tip: make use of the cooler morning and evening for your shopping or walk. Take a cooling (foot) bath or a shower.



Take care of each other

In hot weather, pay extra attention to people in your surroundings who might need your help.

Tip: Stop by an extra time or call them and ask what you can do.



Medicines and heat

Some medications can lead to health problems in hot weather because the body's water and salt balance is disrupted. This can lead to dehydration, insufficient sweating, and feeling unwell.

Consult your pharmacy or GP if you have questions about using your medication during heat.

Heat and health

In the accompanying text, the RIVM lists the three most common heat-related health problems. The symptoms are explained, as well as the actions that can be taken to reduce the problem.

Collaboration partners are expected to pay attention to these signals and take appropriate action upon recognizing them.

Source: RIVM

Recognize the symptoms, know what to do!

Overheating

How do you recognize it?

- Fatigue
- Loss of concentration during the day
- Headache
- Dizziness
- Muscle pain
- Swollen ankles (edema)
- Itchy blisters



What are you doing?

Drink plenty of water, tea, or coffee, even if you are not thirsty. Take it easy. A foot bath can help with overheating and swollen ankles. *Contact your GP if the symptoms worsen.*

Heat exhaustion

How do you recognize it?

- Fainting
- Cramp
- Rapid heartbeat
- Heavy sweating
- Pale skin



What are you doing?

Stop what you are doing and find a cool place. Drink plenty of water or sports drink in small sips. Cool your body: take a cold shower or use wet cloths. *If the symptoms do not improve, consult a doctor.*

Heat stroke

How do you recognize it?

- Elevated body temperature of more than 39 degrees
- High heart rate
- Nausea
- Red skin
- Usually no sweat
- Convulsions
- Loss of consciousness



Heatstroke is life-threatening!
Call 112 and follow the instructions of the emergency services.

Execution



3.5 Evaluation and monitoring phase (autumn)

Organization	Taken
Municipality, GGD and all involved organizations	Gather information from the involved (healthcare) organizations through a survey and/or (additional) interviews and analyze where improvements or additions to the Amsterdam heat plan are desired.
Municipality and Public Health Service	Communicating evaluation findings with partners and gathering feedback on the evaluation.

Involved organizations

Thanks go to the following organizations that have contributed to the creation of the Amsterdam Heat Plan. This list of organizations involved in the Amsterdam Heat Plan forms a start, but is not exhaustive. Through annual evaluation and expansion, the list will be supplemented over time with additional organizations and new target groups. Furthermore, the division of roles may be adjusted following the evaluation.

Ambulance Amsterdam

Amsterdam UMC

Amsta

Working conditions service

Fire brigade

Neighborhood Team Amsterdam Southeast

Climate Adaptation Services (CAS)

Door

Evean

GHOR

Amsterdam University of Applied Sciences

Dear HVO

Climate Alliance

Liander

OLVG

Police

Rainbow Group

Red Cross

Safety Region

Waternet





ggd.amsterdam.nl/hitte

Created in collaboration with:

